Francisco von Hafe

Economist | PhD Student in Economics | Health Economics Researcher

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Profile

Health economist and PhD student in Economics at Nova School of Business and Economics, with research spanning digital health, healthcare markets, health-service delivery, economic evaluation and value-based healthcare. My PhD research examines how economic incentives, stakeholder priorities and market mechanisms shape the adoption, participation and value of health and digital-health services, combining systematic evidence synthesis, stakeholder-based research and econometric analysis. This work includes research on market dynamics in digital health and well-being, measurement priorities in case-management interventions for frequent emergency-department users, and empirical analysis of healthcare choices and behaviour. Alongside the PhD, I work as an economist at Value for Health CoLAB and as a researcher at the Comprehensive Health Research Center (CHRC), contributing to economic and cost analysis, reimbursement and implementation models, healthcare-variation research, applied R&D projects and scientific publications. **Google Scholar metrics (Oct 2026):** 77 citations; h-index 5; i10-index 4.

Work Experience

Economist Jan 2020–present
Value for Health CoLAB, Lisbon
- Economic, cost and socioeconomic analysis for value-based healthcare and digital-health projects.
- Collection and analysis of financial, policy and socioeconomic data to inform implementation and reimbursement models for digital healthcare services.
- Research on factors associated with variation in clinical practices in Portugal.
- Project management; contribution to research proposals, scientific articles and applied research outputs.

Integrated Researcher Jan 2020–present
Comprehensive Health Research Center (CHRC), NOVA Medical School

Member / Researcher Dec 2018–present
Health Economics & Management Knowledge Center, Nova SBE

Research Assistant Jul–Dec 2019
Nova School of Business and Economics
- Project: *Limits and opportunities for patients in the health system – lessons from the drug sector*. Supervisor: Pedro Pita Barros.

Education

PhD in Economics Sep 2023–ongoing
Nova School of Business and Economics, NOVA University Lisbon
- Research focus: economic incentives, stakeholder priorities and market mechanisms in health and digital-health services, using systematic reviews, stakeholder-based methods and econometric analysis.

MSc in Economics 2018–2020
Nova School of Business and Economics, NOVA University Lisbon
- Thesis: *The impact of formal home care on spousal health outcomes*. Advisor: Judite Gonçalves, PhD.

BSc in Economics 2015–2018
School of Economics and Management, University of Porto

Peer-Reviewed Publications

von Hafe, F., Santos, A. R., Londral, A. R., Silva, A. M., Lopes, J., Carvalho, N., Ferreira, S., & Azevedo, S. (2026). "Beyond the app: a marketness assessment of digital health, sports, and well-being – a systematic review." *Frontiers in Digital Health*, 8, 1871114. doi:10.3389/fdgth.2026.1871114.

von Hafe, F., Loureiro, D., Azevedo, S., Januário, A., Lourenço, M., Mesquita, A., Guede-Fernández, F., et al. (2026). "What to measure for monitoring and decision-making in a case management intervention for emergency department high-users: different stakeholder priorities." *BMC Health Services Research*. doi:10.1186/s12913-026-15460-8.

Santos, A. R., **von Hafe, F.**, Sampaio, F., Londral, A. R., & Perelman, J. (2026). "Mapping methodologies for economic evaluation of digital health technologies: a scoping review." *Value in Health*, 29(2), 311–323. doi:10.1016/j.jval.2025.09.012.

von Hafe, F., Wagle, Y., Guede-Fernández, F., Giordano, A. P., Silva, L., et al. (2025). "Legal frameworks for blockchain applications: a comparative study with implications for innovation in Europe." *Frontiers in Blockchain*, 8, 1655230. doi:10.3389/fbloc.2025.1655230.

von Hafe, F., Azevedo, S., Fragata, J., & Londral, A. R. (2023). "Initial steps for the Portuguese Atlas of geographical variation in healthcare." *Research in Health Services & Regions*, 2(1), 7. doi:10.1007/s43999-023-00022-w.

Costa, E., Conceição, D. V. N. da, **von Hafe, F.**, & Millett, C. (2023). "The First Quantification of the Carbon Footprint of the Portuguese National Health Service: A Positive but Insufficient Step Forward." *Portuguese Journal of Public Health*, 41(2), 81–82. doi:10.1159/000530426.

Gonçalves, S., **von Hafe, F.**, Martins, F., Menino, C., Guimarães, M. J., Mesquita, A., Sampaio, S., & Londral, A. R. (2022). "Case management intervention of high users of the emergency department of a Portuguese hospital: a before-after design analysis." *BMC Emergency Medicine*, 22, 159. doi:10.1186/s12873-022-00716-3.

Azevedo, S., Guede-Fernández, F., **von Hafe, F.**, Dias, P., Lopes, I., Cardoso, N., et al. (2022). "Scaling-up digital follow-up care services: collaborative development and implementation of Remote Patient Monitoring pilot initiatives to increase access to follow-up care." *Frontiers in Digital Health*, 4, 1006447. doi:10.3389/fdgth.2022.1006447.

Gonçalves, J., **von Hafe, F.**, & Filipe, L. (2021). "Formal home care use and spousal health outcomes." *Social Science & Medicine*, 287, 114373. doi:10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.114373.

Letters, Preprints, Book Chapters & Proceedings

Santos, A. R., **von Hafe, F.**, Sampaio, F., Londral, A. R., & Perelman, J. (2026). "Author Reply" [reply to *Methodological Frameworks for Economic Evaluation of Digital Health Interventions*]. *Value in Health*, 29(9), 1741–1742. doi:10.1016/j.jval.2026.04.015.

Antunes, R., Dias, P., **von Hafe, F.**, Wagle, Y., Silva, L., Guede-Fernandez, F., & Azevedo, S. (2025). "Blockchain-Based Skin Marketplaces in Counter-Strike 2: A Comprehensive Survey." SSRN preprint. doi:10.2139/ssrn.5389950.

von Hafe, F., Gonçalves, J., & Mateus, C. (2024). "The impact of developing green and exercise-friendly spaces in deprived neighborhoods on health and healthy lifestyles: A systematic literature review." In *Environmental Health Behavior: Concepts, Determinants, Impacts, and Research Methods*. Elsevier, pp. 147–163.

von Hafe, F., Azevedo, S., Freitas, L., Cação, H., Viveiros, G., & Londral, A. R. (2024). "Exploring socio-economic networks characteristics in the virtual sports market: A systematic review." In *Book of Abstracts, 11th International Conference on Business Servitization*, pp. 337–345.

Silva, R., **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., Guede-Fernández, F., & Londral, A. R. (2023). "Popularizing Terminology Using Social Networks: Keeping Citizens Informed About Value in Health Care." *CEUR Workshop Proceedings*, vol. 3427.

Londral, A., Fragata, J., **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., Oliosi, E., Guede, F., & Silva, R. (2023). *Atlas da Variação em Saúde no Serviço Nacional de Saúde Português – 2018*. Value for Health CoLAB.

Selected R&D Projects

- **COMHOM** (2025–2027) – EU-funded, five-country project co-creating more inclusive and effective homelessness-response systems through Living Labs and participatory research.
- **HUMAI** (2025–2026) – AI-assisted case-management platform for frequent emergency-department users, combining early risk identification, personalised intervention and impact/cost assessment.
- **Blockchain.PT** (2023–2026) – National blockchain innovation agenda; VOH.CoLAB contributed scientific validation, stakeholder research and market/value analysis for sports and gaming applications.
- **CardioFollow.AI** (2021–2023) – AI-powered telemonitoring after cardiothoracic surgery, including remote patient monitoring, predictive risk modelling and value/cost analysis.
- **Atlas of Variation in Healthcare** (2022–2023) – Open-access mapping of geographic variation in Portuguese healthcare indicators to support research and policy on equity, efficiency and access.
- **FrailCare.AI** (2020–2022) – AI-supported telecare for older adults at risk of frailty, with evaluation of effectiveness, cost-efficiency and scalability.
- **HGO Emergency High Users** (2020–2021) – Evaluation of care pathways, outcomes and costs for frequent emergency-department users under a multidisciplinary case-management programme.
- **Fast Track COVID** (2020–2021) – National SARS-CoV-2 serological screening strategy supporting evidence-based resource allocation and public-health decisions.
- **EasyHealth4COVID** (2020–2021) – Co-design and evaluation of a telecare solution for high-risk citizens and nursing-home professionals during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Selected Conference Contributions

- **von Hafe, F.**, Wagle, Y., Guede-Fernández, F., et al. (2025). "Comparison of Country-Specific Blockchain Legislation with the European Union: A Case Study of Portugal, Switzerland, and Estonia." International Conference on WEB3: Tokenization, Technology and Culture, University of Aveiro, Portugal, 11 April.
- **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., Freitas, L., Cação, H., Viveiros, G., & Londral, A. R. (2024). "Exploring Socio-Economic Networks Characteristics in the Virtual Sports Market: A Systematic Review." 11th International Conference on Business Servitization, Lisbon.
- Silva, R., **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., Guede-Fernández, F., & Londral, A. R. (2023). "Popularizing Terminology Using Social Networks: Keeping Citizens Informed About Value in Health Care." 2nd International Conference on Multilingual Digital Terminology Today, Lisbon.
- Azevedo, S., **von Hafe, F.**, Vieira, A. C. L., & Londral, A. R. (2022). "Value Scorecard – What Matters the Most? A Tool to Iteratively Improve and Successfully Implement Remote Patient Monitoring Service After Cardiothoracic Surgery." ISPOR Europe 2022, Vienna.
- Azevedo, S., **von Hafe, F.**, Vieira, A. C. L., & Londral, A. R. (2022). "Implementing Value For Health Scorecards co-created with healthcare professionals to measure the value of RPM-based services for cardiothoracic surgery." ICHOM Conference 2022, Boston.
- **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., & Londral, A. (2022). "Variation in cesarean section and hip surgery within 48 hours after admission in Portuguese public hospitals." 3rd CHRC Annual Summit.
- **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., & Londral, A. (2022). "Unwarranted variation: Kick-off steps for the Portuguese context." Wennberg International Collaborative Spring Policy Meeting.
- **von Hafe, F.**, Azevedo, S., & Londral, A. (2021). "The cost-analysis of digitizing the care process in a nursing home: a pilot study." 17th Portuguese National Conference on Health Economics.
- **von Hafe, F.**, Gonçalves, S., Martins, F., & Londral, A. (2021). "A cost analysis of an intervention targeting emergency department high users." 17th Portuguese National Conference on Health Economics.

Teaching & Executive Education

Teaching Assistant – Principles of Microeconomics (BSc) Sep 2025–present
Nova School of Business and Economics

Grader – Economics of Healthcare Systems 2025–present
Nova School of Business and Economics

Invited Faculty – Value-Based Healthcare: From Theory to Practice Apr 2026
Leadership in Healthcare Delivery, 12th edition, Nova SBE Executive Education / Roche
- Taught costing, value-based pricing and reimbursement frameworks, including application to digital health.

Invited Speaker Mar 2025
JoinHealth Spring Welcome Webinar, Health Cluster Portugal
- "Cost Measurement in Value-Based Healthcare: Strategies for Sustainable Pricing & Reimbursement."

Lecturer 2025
Advanced Training in Analytical Accounting for the Portuguese NHS, Nova SBE / ACSS

Invited Lecturer 2022
Workshop on Value-Based Healthcare Concepts and Knowledge, Postgraduate Course, NOVA Medical School

Professional Training

- Scientific Writing and Communication in Conferences, Instituto de Saúde Ambiental, Faculdade de Medicina, Universidade de Lisboa (2022).
- Yellow Belt in Value-Based Healthcare, European Decision Institute (2021).

Languages & Technical Skills

Languages	Portuguese (native); English (C1, FCE); Spanish (B1).
Data / software	R, Stata, EViews, Excel, Access, PowerPoint, Word.
Methods / domains	Health economics, economic evaluation, cost analysis, healthcare variation, digital health, value-based healthcare, project management, scientific writing.